

1968

The Coming Of Intel And The Software Industry

July: Intel Arrives

Robert Noyce and Gordon Moore, employees at Fairchild Semiconductor, which they had co-founded, started another venture on their own. Initially called Moore Noyce Electronics, they decided to change the name since it sounded similar to “more noise”. They operated briefly under the name NM Electronics, till finally deciding on “Integrated Electronics”, shortened to Intel.

October: Apollo 7—ICs On Board!

Apollo 7 was launched. The predecessor to Apollo 11 which landed on the moon a year later, the Apollo 7 was a manned, earth-orbiting spacecraft that was in space for 11 days. The navigation control was managed by the onboard Apollo Guidance Computer, built by Raytheon. It contained 4,000 Integrated Circuits. Being a major buyer of integrated circuits, it is acknowledged that the space program was instrumental in advances in integrated circuits. The Apollo Guidance Computer was also part of the lunar landing Apollo 11.

December: The software industry as no-one knew it

IBM was faced with a lawsuit accusing it of bundling software and system engineering services along with the hardware, which restricted opportunities for other vendors. The result was the bifurcation of the hardware and software services of IBM. Henceforth, IBM had to price and sell software discretely from the hardware. This step is considered to have lead to the creation of a distinct software industry.

December: Doug Engelbart's all-included system

Called the “Mother of all Demos”, Douglas Engelbart demonstrated the NLS (Online system) in a 90-minute live demonstration at the Joint Computer Conference in San Francisco. The NLS system incorporates hypertext and distributed collaboration, keyboard, keypad, mouse, windows and video conferencing—far ahead of their time.